

References for Sector Standards:

The current sector recommended timeframes, for what is considered overdue or unresponsive have been taken from the following documents. Loop will update these if other standards are set.

Loop has cross checked these timeframes with a number of professionals in the field and all have agreed that these are a reasonable timeframe (if not too long) for each step of the process.

Time to acknowledge receipt	48 hours	IASC Global Standard Operating Procedures on Inter-Agency Cooperation in Community-Based Complaints Mechanisms, 4.2.2(b)
	Overdue after 1 week	
Time to assess an allegation	Overdue after 6 weeks	IASC Global Implementation of PSEA in Humanitarian Response Dashboard : Average time taken for an investigation to be initiated, upon receipt of an allegation (14 days). The timeframe given in Loop (6 weeks) is longer than the average period following discussions with stakeholders.
	Unresponsive after 3 months	IASC Minimum Operating Standards on PSEA (2012) section 8, indicator 5: Investigations are commenced within 3 months
Time to complete investigation	Overdue after 6 months	UN Department of Peacekeeping Operations deadline for completing investigation: 6 months (A/09/779 13 February 2015), shortened to 3 months for urgent cases (A/70/729 16 February 2016).
	Unresponsive after 2 years	Core Humanitarian Standard Commitment 5 indicator: investigations to be completed in a timely manner; Statement of Commitment on Eliminating Sexual Exploitation and Abuse by UN and Non-UN Personnel no. 6: Investigate allegations of sexual exploitation and abuse in a timely and professional manner.
Time to inform author	Overdue 48 hours after Investigation is complete.	IASC Global SOPs on CBCMs, 4.3.4; IASC MOS PSEA section 8, indicator 5 (information about outcome is shared with complainant)